

PART B: Sourcing Strategy + Scale-Up Proposal

Question 1: Sourcing Methods

To identify companies matching the Federer ICP across India, I focused on **high-signal, structured sources** rather than generic search. The goal was to find companies that already show **evidence of manufacturing, technical depth, and activity**, instead of relying on surface-level listings.

1. Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)

The MCA is the official registry of Indian companies, containing information on directors, filings, and business classifications.

It is relevant because it confirms whether a company is legitimate, helps identify promoter-driven structures, and filing history can indirectly show activity levels.

Its limitations are that financial data is restricted without paid access, and NIC codes are broad, often requiring manual classification for accuracy.

2. DSIR R&D Directory

This directory lists companies that have approved in-house R&D centers.

It is useful because it signals technical capability, innovation focus, and helps identify companies that differentiate themselves through research.

The limitation is that the dataset is relatively small and misses companies that do not have formal DSIR recognition.

3. Udyam MSME Database

The Udyam database captures small and mid-sized enterprises, especially those with turnover below ₹500Cr.

It is relevant because it filters mid-market firms and helps identify emerging manufacturers in the target segment.

Its drawback is that the data is self-reported, which means it requires validation to exclude traders or service providers.

4. Chemexcil Member Directory

Chemexcil provides a directory of export-focused companies with verified activity.

It is relevant because export presence is a strong proxy for growth and indicates compliance with international quality standards.

The limitation is that it includes commodity exporters, so filtering is needed to focus on specialty manufacturers.

5. Zauba Import/Export Data

Zauba offers shipment-level data that reveals real operational activity.

It is relevant because it helps distinguish active manufacturers from inactive firms, and shipment frequency can serve as a growth signal.

Its limitation is that HS codes require careful interpretation, and the dataset includes traders who need to be filtered out.

6. BDMA (Bulk Drug Manufacturers Association)

BDMA is a cluster of pharma and intermediate manufacturers.

It is relevant because it concentrates companies with manufacturing capabilities and helps identify players in regulated segments.

The limitation is that it also includes large generic pharma firms, which means filtering is necessary to focus on the right subset.

7. TSIIC Industrial Directory

This directory lists companies operating in industrial zones.

It is relevant because it strongly indicates manufacturing presence and provides details about physical plant locations. Its limitation is that the data is regional and can be partially outdated, reducing reliability for broader analysis.

Question 2: The 1000-Company Proposal

Objective: The goal is to build a **list of 1000 ICP-qualified companies within 30 days**. The focus is on balancing **scale** (starting wide to ensure coverage) and **quality** (multi-layer filtering to eliminate noise). This ensures the final dataset is not just large, but **high-confidence and business-ready**. The goal is to balance speed, accuracy and validation.

Overall Procedure

1. Initial Universe Creation

- **Sources chosen:**
 - **MCA + Udyam:** Provide legitimacy and MSME-scale companies.
 - **Chemexcil + Zauba:** Capture export-oriented and growth-focused firms.
 - **DSIR + BDMA:** Identify technically strong, R&D-driven, regulated pharma/chemical players.
 - **TSIIC:** Adds manufacturing presence through industrial zone listings.
- **Explanation:** Each source contributes a unique dimension—legitimacy, scale, growth, technical quality, and physical presence. Combining them ensures diversity and reduces blind spots.
- **Expected Output:** ~4000 companies (broad base to filter down).

2. Automated Qualification Pipeline

- **Stage 1 — Initial Filtering (Automated):**
 - Criteria: Active website, India-specific location, revenue proxy <₹500Cr.
 - **Why:** These are hard filters that quickly eliminate irrelevant or oversized firms.
 - **Expected Output:** ~2800 companies.
- **Stage 2 — Sanity Filter (Semi-Automated):**
 - Remove CROs, traders, distributors, and generic pharma.
 - Approach: Keyword detection + website scraping + simple classification model.
 - **Why:** These categories are common false positives and dilute ICP quality.
 - **Expected Output:** ~1500 companies.
- **Stage 3 — Priority Filter (AI-assisted + manual):**
 - Apply Federer signals:
 - C1: Manufacturing evidence
 - C2: India Based
 - C3: Differentiation (R&D, certifications)
 - C4: Technical decision-maker presence
 - C5: Growing Sector (Tailwind)
 - C6: Growth signals (exports, activity)
 - Pipeline: AI extraction for speed, human validation for flagged edge cases.

- **Why:** This step ensures nuanced judgment beyond simple filters.
- **Expected Output:** ~1000–1100 companies.

Timeline + Weekly Tasks

Week 1 — Universe Building

- Source ~4000 companies from MCA, Udyam, Chemexcil, Zauba, BDMA, TSIIC.
- Deduplicate and normalize data.
- **Output:** ~4000 companies.

Week 2 — Automated Filtering

- Apply Stage 1 (hard filters) → reduce to ~2800.
- Apply Stage 2 (sanity filters) → reduce to ~1500.
- Manual review of ~200–300 flagged edge cases.
- **Output:** ~1500 companies.

Week 3 — Evaluation & Scoring

- Apply Federer scoring (C1–C6).
- AI-assisted extraction for speed.
- Manual validation (~45–60 sec per company).
- Focus on differentiation, technical leadership, and growth signals.
- **Output:** ~1000–1100 companies.

Week 4 — Finalization

- Re-check borderline cases.
- Remove weak fits.
- Ensure evidence-backed scoring and consistency.
- **Output:** Final shortlist of ~1000 ICP-qualified companies.

Quality Control

- **Flagging system:** Companies with unclear signals are flagged for manual review.
- **Human validation:** 20–30% of companies checked manually for accuracy.
- **Cross-verification:** Website + LinkedIn + directory data.
- **Strict rejection rules:** CRO/service-heavy, revenue > ₹500Cr, no recent activity.
- **Why:** This layered QC ensures the dataset is reliable and reduces false positives.

Yield Expectations

Stage	Companies
Initial universe	~4000
After Stage 1	~2800

After Stage 2	~1500
After Evaluation	~1000–1100
Final ICP set	~1000

Key Design Principles

- **Automate repetitive tasks, not judgment.**
- **Use signals, not labels** (e.g., facility presence > “manufacturer” tag).
- **Iterative expansion > one-time search.**
- **Human validation for edge cases.**

Conclusion

This system is designed to balance **scale (starting wide with ~4000 companies)**, **accuracy (multi-layer filtering + validation)**, and **efficiency (AI-assisted pipeline with human oversight)**. The final output will be a **high-quality, ICP-aligned dataset of ~1000 companies**, ready for business use.